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PAROMIK CHAKRABORTY

## 1 "A PUBLIC PRIVATE-PARTNERSHIP Is Imperative To... Transform The Mobility Landscape Of The Country"

➤ India's metro cities suffer from congested traffic, stagnant bottlenecks and massive on-road delays, daily. Analytical insights on traffic patterns can help city runners plan routes and traffic management strategies better. Paromik Chakraborty of *Electronics For You* speaks with Prabhjeet Singh, head of cities, India and South Asia, Uber, about how their platform Uber Movement can improve the notorious urban traffic conditions

**Q. What are the major challenges faced by Indian roads, and how heavily do those lead to peak traffic conditions?**

**A.** Transportation in India is highly fragmented and disorganised across various modes, with poor infrastructure and low public transport density. Delhi has the highest share—45 per cent—of people using private cars for commuting, whereas Bengaluru sees 38 per cent of people doing so.

According to an April 2018 study done by Boston Consulting Group, traffic congestion during peak hours in four major cities, namely, New Delhi, Mumbai, Bengaluru and Kolkata, costs the economy a whopping US\$ 22 billion annually.

Travellers in these four cities spend 1.5 hours more on their daily commutes than their counterparts in other Asian cities during peak traffic times. Peak-hour congestion, which indicates the excess time taken during peak traffic to travel a given distance, in these four Indian cities is estimated at 149 per cent. This is much higher than the Asian average of 67 per cent. In such a situation, riders and drivers have to undertake multiple challenges daily.

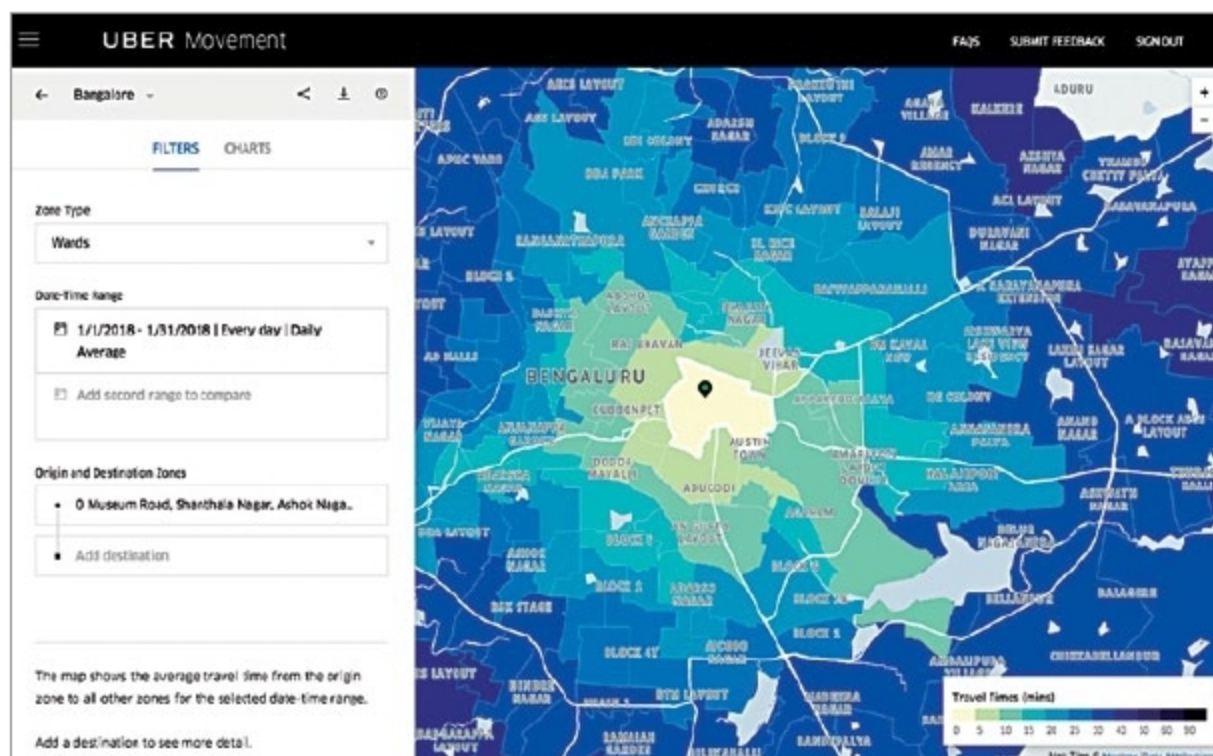
**Q. How does Uber Movement collect necessary traffic data and generate insights?**

**A.** Uber Movement is a free public website that makes Uber's network data available to help governments and urban planners, regarding travel times in various transport corridors. It is designed to address the challenges faced by urban planners and departments of transportation staff, and help them make informed decisions on infrastructure, urban mobility and traffic management.

Uber Movement shows data from billions of rides taken with Uber, aggregated into zones covering

standard boundaries used by urban planners. It matches anonymised GPS trace pings from Uber trips to zones (such as Census Tracts), selects the median ping for each zone a trip passes through and then measures the elapsed time between medians of various zones to provide zone-to-zone travel time aggregates at an hourly level.

**Q. So far, in how many cities has Uber Movement been deployed? Can you share some case studies?**



Uber Movement in Bengaluru; map showing average travel time from origin zone to other zones for the selected date-time range